

GitHub's Documented Pull Request Workflow

Contributor, Review, Revision, and Merge Process

Visual Documentation Case Study

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Version History

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1. Overview

This visual documentation case study demonstrates how complex technical information can be analyzed, structured, and translated into a purposeful visualization. It presents the context and source material behind the visualization, the communication problem it addresses, the intended audience, and the design decisions used to determine its scope, structure, and level of detail.

The case study includes the resulting visualization and identifies the source material used to understand and represent the subject.



2. Case Study Fields

Each case study follows a consistent structure to document the context, communication need, intended audience, visualization approach, and supporting references behind the resulting visual solution.

Table 1 Case Study Fields

Source Field	Description
Source & Context	What information or system was studied and where the visualization originated
Communication Problem	What aspect of the information is difficult to understand or needs clarification
Audience	Who the visualization is intended to help
Design Decisions	Why a particular diagram type, scope, structure, and level of detail were selected
Visualization	The resulting visual solution
Source Material	The authoritative references used to understand and verify the subject

2.1. Source & Context

This visualization is based on **GitHub's documented pull request workflow**. Pull requests provide a collaborative process for proposing, reviewing, discussing, validating, and merging changes before they become part of the target branch.

2.2. Communication Problem

The documented workflow involves activities performed by both the change author and the reviewer, together with the repository-level actions and checks.

The visualization is intended to make the sequence of activities, responsibilities, review outcomes, and feedback loop easier to understand.

2.3. Audience

New team members who understand the basic Git concepts but are unfamiliar with collaborative pull request workflows in GitHub.

2.4. Design Decisions

A **Cross-Functional Flowchart** is selected to show how activities move between the contributor, GitHub, and reviewer throughout the pull request process. The visualization shows who does what, and emphasizes **activities, responsibilities, handoffs, and the primary review-and-revision cycle.**

- Stacked pull requests
- Merge conflicts
- Auto-merge
- Branch protection configuration
- Repository-specific rules

2.5. Visualization

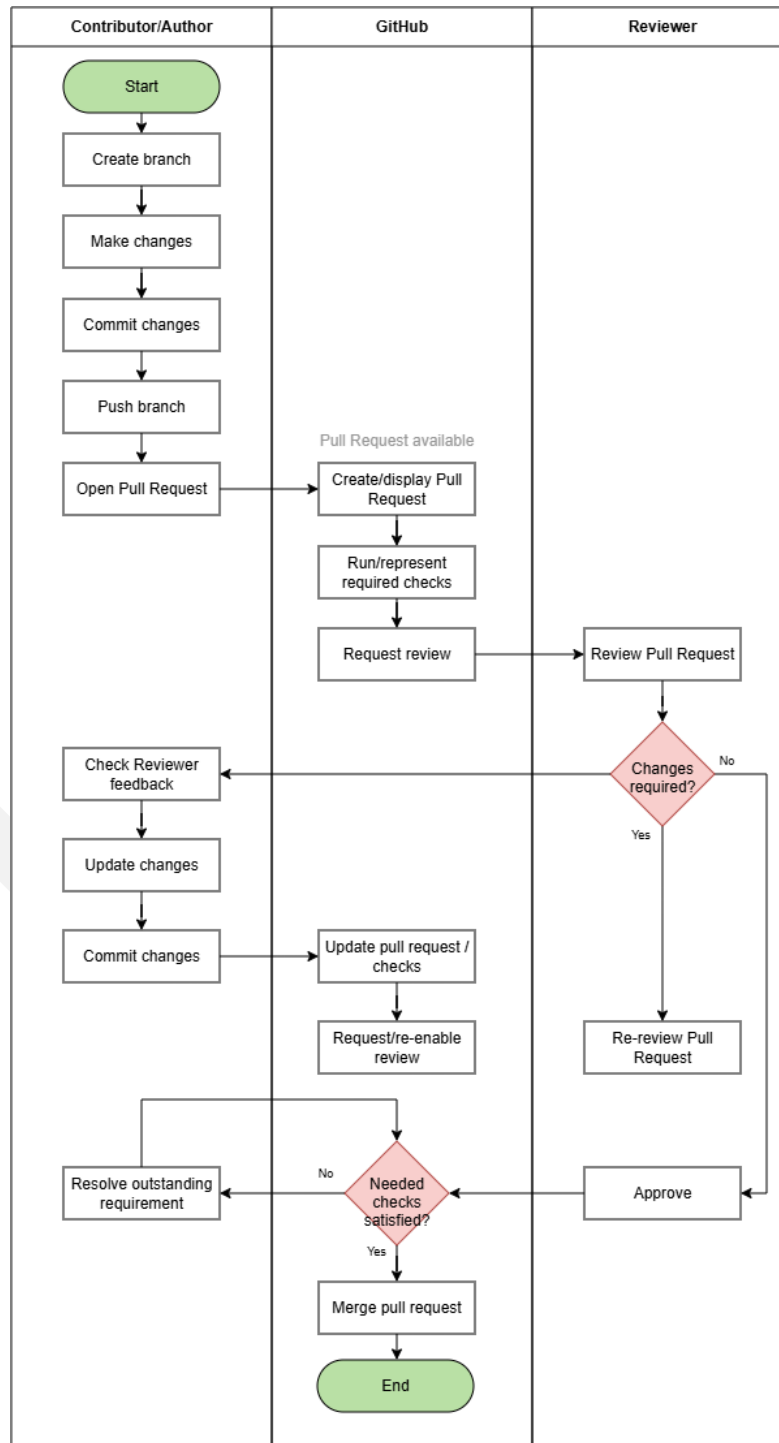


Figure 1 GitHub's Documented Pull Request Workflow

2.6. Source Material

The following are the links to the original public documentation/repository:

- [GitHub - About pull requests](#)
- [GitHub - Giving reviews](#)

